

THE PERFECT DAY EXERCISE

Some couples could spend the next five years playing whack-a-mole with various financial issues: One partner spends more; the other saves more. One partner wants lavish vacations; the other is fine with cheap motels. And on and on. If you find yourself in the weeds—that is, spinning your wheels on the same issues you’ve talked about over and over—then *stop*. Take a different approach!

Today, I want you to consider what your perfect day together would look like as it relates to money.

» Would you talk about money? When? For how long?

» Would one of you have to goad the other into saving money? Or would money be automatically transferred to savings? If so, how much?

» Would you go out to eat? How would you decide what to order? What would you tip?

» What else would you spend money on during your day together?

Run through these questions with your partner if you feel comfortable. The magic of this exercise is in the details, so get specific. Then find one area of agreement you can start implementing immediately.